

man-to-man talk with him. I informed George bluntly that I thought there was considerable room for improvement in the manner in which he was handling his job.

"It's funny, but I need only to spend an hour on one of the sites and I spot several things we could do better or cheaper and increase production and profits," I told him.

"Frankly, I can't understand why you don't see them, too."

"But you *own* the properties," the superintendent declared. "You have a direct personal interest in everything that happens on or to them. That's enough to sharpen any man's eyes to ways of saving—and thereby making—more money."

Truth to tell, I'd never thought of it in quite that way before. I mulled over what George said for several days and then decided to try an experiment. I had another talk with Miller.

"Look, George. Suppose I farm the properties out to you,"

I suggested. "Instead of paying you a salary, I'll give you a percent of the profits. The more efficient our operations, the bigger those profits will be—and the more money you'll make."

Miller gave the proposition some thought and then accepted the offer enthusiastically.

The change was immediate—and little short of miracu-lous. As soon as George realized that he, too, had a "direct personal interest" in the properties he really hit his stride.

No longer merely a salaried employee, the superintendent

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became keenly concerned with cutting costs, boosting production and increasing the profits in which he was to share.